Reference tools for translating Akkadian (and later Sumerian) texts into Hebrew: catalogue

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Compiled 2026-10-16. The audience is future translation sessions; this will be merged into the translation guidelines.

Legend. Access: FREE-API, FREE-BULK (downloadable data), FREE-PDF, FREE-WEB (HTML only), PAID, LIB (library/print only).
✔ = URL or API call tested with `curl` on 2026-10-16 (HTTP 200 + expected content). **(unverified)** = from catalogues or search results only. Sub-folders of `Reference-tools/` hold saved docs, sample responses, and a README per resource. Comparative flood studies are catalogued separately in `../Comparative-studies/INDEX.md`.

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0. TL;DR: the default workflow for one line of Gilgameš XI / Atraḫasīs

1. **Text + normalisation + lemmas + English:** eBL corpus API ✔
   `GET https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/4/chapters/Standard%20Babylonian/XI/display` (Gilg. = `L/1/4`, Atraḫasīs = `L/1/1`). Every word has a `uniqueLemma` id such as `abūbu I`.
2. **Meaning:** `GET https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/words/<id>` ✔ returns the **full CDA entry**, plus the CDA addenda, AfO-Register references, SAD and logograms.
3. **Usage across the literary corpus:** `GET https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/corpus/query?lemmas=<id>` ✔ lists every occurrence. Use it to keep the translation consistent.
4. **Hard words:** CAD volume PDF (free, ✔) + eSAD (Leipzig corrections, free PDF ✔).
5. **Hebrew side:** Sefaria `/api/words/<Hebrew>` ✔ (Klein etymology notes give Akkadian cognates; BDB root preambles) → then Tawil / HALOT (paid) for the Akkadian↔Hebrew semantics.
6. **Reading the transliteration notation:** `ORACC-ATF-and-lemmatization-docs/atf-inline-tutorial.md` + `eBL-ATF-spec/ebl-atf.md`.

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1. Akkadian lexica

Resource	URL	Access	Machine access
eBL Dictionary (= the full **CDA**, Black/George/Postgate 2000, reproduced with Harrassowitz's permission, + CDA addenda, AfO-Register/AGI, SAD, Schramm logograms, ORACC lemma links, Arabic glosses)	https://www.ebl.lmu.de/dictionary · API `https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/words`	FREE-API ✔. Content © (the "About" page says reproduction needs permission), so query it, don't mirror it.	`GET /api/words/<id>` ✔; search `?word` (lemma prefix) ✔, `?meaning=` (Englis substring) ✔, `?root=kpr` ✔, `?vowelClass=a/u` ✔, `&origin=CDA` ✔; batch `?lemmas=id1,id2` ✔ (100 ids pe call OK); **all ids:** `/api/words/all` ✔ (22,256). Details and JSON structur `eBL-API/README.md`
CAD: *Assyrian Dictionary of the Oriental Institute*, 21 vols / 26 PDFs, 1956–2010	https://isac.uchicago.edu/publications/search?text=&sort_by=year_desc&publication_series%5B62%5D=62	FREE-PDF ✔ (all 26 return 200; ≈ 788 MB). © ISAC, whose terms forbid redistribution and **AI training or dataset compilation** without permission.	Direct S3 URLs `https://isac-assets.s3.amazonaws.com/isac-publications/cad_<x>.pdf`. Full table with sizes: `CAD-Chicago-Assyrian-Dictionary/README.md` + `cad-volumes.csv`. The text layer has garbled diacritics (š→ß), so search unaccented.
eSAD: electronic *Supplement to the Akkadian Dictionaries* (Streck, Leipzig)	https://www.gkr.uni-leipzig.de/en/draft/altorientalisches-institut/forschung/supplement-to-the-akkadian-dictionaries	FREE-PDF ✔ (open access)	Complete PDF `.../Supplement_Dateien/eSAD_complet min.pdf` ✔ (4.85 MB), plus per-letter PDFs (A.pdf, B.pdf …)
AHw: von Soden, *Akkadisches Handwörterbuch* (1959–81)	—	PAID / LIB. No legal free digital copy found.	—
CDA print (Harrassowitz, 2nd corr. printing 2000)	https://www.harrassowitz-verlag.de/title_443.ahtml	PAID, about €29 (publisher list price per search; unverified)	—

Resource	URL	Access	Machine access
ORACC glossaries (per-project, lemmatised, with attested forms and frequencies)	https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/json/	FREE-BULK ✔, **CC0**	Zip per project, e.g. `json/cams-gkab.zip` ✔ (29 MB; `gloss-akk-x-stdbab.json`, 4,019 SB entries), `json/saao-saa03.zip` (SAA 3 Court Poetry & Literary Miscellanea), `json/rinap.zip`. **The per-file URLs (`/<proj>/gloss-akk.json`, `manifest.json`) return empty bodie** so use the zips. Format: `ORACC-ATF and-lemmatization-docs/opendata-jso format.md`
AAF Akkadian Dictionary (Association Assyrophile de France, O. Lauffenburger)	https://www.assyrianlanguages.org/akkadian/	FREE-WEB ✔ (© AAF)	Entry by numeric id: `dosearch.php?searchkey=<N>&language=id` ✔ (~11,000 ids). English search: POST `dosearch.php` with `latinkey=flood&language=english` ✔.
AGI: Sommerfeld, *Akkadische Glossare und Indizes* (AfO-Register digitised)	https://open.uni-marburg.de/handle/10.17192/es.2015.0015	FREE (repository page ✔; file download link not verified by curl)	Also merged into eBL (`akkadischeGlossareUndIndices`)
Schramm, *Akkadische Logogramme* (²2010)	https://univerlag.uni-goettingen.de/handle/3/isbn-978-3-941875-65-4	FREE-PDF ✔, CC BY-ND; **saved** in `Schramm-2010--Akkadische-Logogramme/`	Also in eBL (`logograms`, `/api/signs/<NAME>`)
Kaufman, *The Akkadian Influences on Aramaic* (AS 19, 1974)	https://isac-assets.s3.amazonaws.com/isac-publications/as19.pdf	FREE-PDF ✔ (7.7 MB; errata `as19_errata.pdf` ✔). © ISAC terms.	PDF
Leipzig Akkadian Dictionary (new SAW project)	https://www.saw-leipzig.de/en/research/projects/leipzig-akkadian-dictionary	project page ✔; no data yet (unverified)	—

2. Sumerian (for later phases)

Resource	URL	Access	Machine acces
ePSD2: *electronic Pennsylvania Sumerian Dictionary* 2	https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/epsd2/sux ✔ (15,944 entries)	FREE-WEB + FREE-BULK ✔ (CC0 data)	`https://oracc.mu` ✔ (213 MB; con corpora: `epsd2-emesal.zip`, `epsd`
ETCSL: Electronic Text Corpus of Sumerian Literature (Oxford)	https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/	FREE-WEB: **timed out from this machine (unverified)**. Wayback snapshot of 2024-12-29 ✔: https://web.archive.org/web/2024/https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/. TEI XML was historically on the Oxford Text Archive (ota.bodleian.ox.ac.uk, also timed out).	Its literary data `literary` and `etcs`
Halloran, *Sumerian Lexicon* v3.0	http://www.sumerian.org/sumerlex.htm ✔ · PDF http://www.sumerian.org/sumerian.pdf ✔ (0.5 MB)	FREE-WEB (v3); v4 is a paid book (Logogram Publishing 2006)	HTML/PDF
ORACC OSL/OGSL sign lists	https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/osl/ ✔	FREE-BULK ✔ (`json/osl.zip`, `json/ogsl.zip`, `json/ogsl-signlist.zip`)	JSON

3. Grammar, signs, notation

Resource	URL	Access	Use it for...			
ORACC ATF documentation (primer, inline tutorial, structure, quick reference, translations, composites/scores, lemmatisation, *Akkadian conventions*, JSON format)	https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/doc/help/	FREE ✔ (CC BY-SA 3.0); **saved** in `ORACC-ATF-and-lemmatization-docs/` (18 pages, raw HTML + clean MD)	**Mandatory reading** before interpreting any ORACC, CDLI or eBL transliteration (`{d}`, `[]`, `#`, `!`, `?`, CAPS logograms, `%n`). Also covers the Akkadian normalisation and citation-form conventions (`akkadian-language-conventions.md`).			
eBL-ATF specification	https://github.com/ElectronicBabylonianLiterature/ebl-api/blob/master/docs/ebl-atf.md	FREE ✔ (MIT); **saved** in `eBL-ATF-spec/`	The eBL dialect: normalised lines, `	`and`		` me mark manu lines chap ATF.
eBL signs API	`https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/signs/<NAME>` ✔, `/api/signs?value=kur&sublndex=1` ✔, `/api/signs?listsName=MZL&listsNumber=578` ✔, `/api/signs/all` ✔ (2,497)	FREE-API	Sign → values, logograms, numbers in MZL/HZL/LAK/OBZL/SLLHA. Works as a machine substitute for Borger's MZL.			
Huehnergard, *A Grammar of Akkadian* (3rd ed., Eisenbrauns 2011; HSS 45) + *Key*	(publisher pages returned 404/403; unverified)	PAID: about $50–65 (grammar) and about $30–55 (key), per retailer snippets (unverified). No open edition; the 3rd edition per its description adds an appendix of Semitic/Hebrew cognates. **Do not use** the PDFs that circulate on university servers and shadow sites.	The standard English reference grammar. Paradigms, normalisation rules, SB vs OB.			
Other grammars	Caplice, *Introduction to Akkadian* (Biblical Institute Press, paid); Ungnad/Matouš, *Grammatik des Akkadischen* (paid); Worthington, *Complete Babylonian* (Teach Yourself, paid, about £25, unverified); Streck, *Altbabylonisches Lehrbuch* (German, paid); Hugenberger & Erickson, *Basics of Akkadian* (Zondervan, paid)	PAID	**No openly licensed Akkadian grammar was found.** Use the eBL normalisations plus the ORACC conventions doc as the working reference.			

Resource	URL	Access	Use it for...			
Borger, *Mesopotamisches Zeichenlexikon* (AOAT 305, ²2010, Ugarit-Verlag)	(price not found; unverified)	PAID	The standard sign list. eBL signs API + ORACC OSL cover our needs.			

4. Akkadian ↔ Hebrew comparative tools

Resource	URL	Access	Machine access
Sefaria lexicons: Klein, BDB, Jastrow, Ben-Yehuda	`https://www.sefaria.org/api/words/<Hebrew>` ✔	FREE-API. **Klein = CC BY-NC** (Carta 1987); BDB, Jastrow = PD	Per word ✔; autocomplete `/api/words/completion/<prefix>/K` ✔; bulk only via the 2.6 GB Mor Details: `Sefaria-lexicon-API/REAI`
BDB (PD) as data	https://github.com/openscriptures/HebrewLexicon ✔ (`BrownDriverBriggs.xml` 2.9 MB)	FREE-BULK (PD content; the readme calls it "a work in progress")	XML keyed to Strong's
STEPBible TBESH	https://github.com/STEPBible/STEPBible-Data/tree/master/Lexicons ✔	FREE-BULK, CC BY	TSV
StarLing *Semitic etymology* database (Militarev & Kogan; the data behind the *Semitic Etymological Dictionary*)	https://starlingdb.org/cgi-bin/response.cgi?root=config&morpho=0&basename=%5Cdata%5Csemham%5Csemet&first=1 ✔ (2,923 records)	FREE-WEB	Paged HTML (`first=N`), with a q

Resource	URL	Access	Machine access
Tawil, *An Akkadian Lexical Companion for Biblical Hebrew* (Ktav 2009, 456/503 pp., ISBN 978-1-60280-114-1)	https://ktav.com/products/an-akkadian-lexical-companion-for-biblical-hebrew (curl got 404; search shows softcover list price **$79.50**)	PAID; no e-book found	—
HALOT: Koehler–Baumgartner, *Hebrew and Aramaic Lexicon of the OT*	Brill. Logos (≈ $160) and Accordance (≈ $149–299) digital editions (search snippets; unverified)	PAID	(Logos/Accordance app)
Mankowski, *Akkadian Loanwords in Biblical Hebrew* (HSS 47, Eisenbrauns 2000, 232 pp.)	https://hmane.harvard.edu/publications/akkadian-loanwords-biblical-hebrew (403 to curl)	PAID / LIB. No open-access copy found.	—
Kaufman, *Akkadian Influences on Aramaic*	see §1	FREE-PDF ✔	—
Cohen, *Biblical Hapax Legomena in the Light of Akkadian and Ugaritic* (SBLDS 37, Scholars Press 1978)	—	LIB / used copies (no OA found)	—
Militarev & Kogan, *Semitic Etymological Dictionary* I (body parts, AOAT 278/1, 2000), II (animal names, AOAT 278/2, 2005)	Ugarit-Verlag (vol. II listed at €17, sold out)	PAID / LIB	(StarLing for the data)

Resource	URL	Access	Machine access
Kogan, *Genealogical Classification of Semitic* (De Gruyter 2015)	(unverified)	PAID; possibly OA on De Gruyter (unverified)	—
Gesenius: Hebrew grammar (Kautzsch–Cowley 1910) and lexicon (Tregelles)	archive.org / Wikisource scans (PD; unverified individually)	FREE (PD)	—
Hebrew-language Assyriology	HUJI course catalogue ("The Akkadian Flood story", course 42556, shnaton.huji.ac.il, found by search; unverified); Klein & Shifra, *בימים הרחוקים ההם: אנתולוגיה משירת המזרח הקדום* (Am Oved 1996; PAID or out of print); Shifra & Klein, *עלילות גלגמש; אנציקלופדיה מקראית* entries (Bialik, PAID); *שנתון לחקר המקרא והמזרח הקדום* (articles, partly on JSTOR)	mostly PAID / LIB	—

5. Text corpora with API (for reference)

Resource	URL	Access	Notes
eBL corpus (Gilgameš all versions, Atraḫasīs OB/MB/SB/NA, Enūma eliš, Erra, Ludlul …)	`https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts` ✔	FREE-API	84 texts. Composite normalised text + English translation + lemmatisation + manuscripts. See `eBL-API/README.md`.
eBL Fragmentarium	`https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/fragments/<museum no.>` ✔, `/api/fragments/query?lemmas=<id>` ✔	FREE-API	Individual tablets (e.g. K.252).
ORACC projects	https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/json/ ✔	FREE-BULK (CC0)	Lemmatised corpora (SAA, RINAP, CAMS/GKAB …).
CDLI	https://cdli.earth/ ✔ (site); data mirror https://github.com/cdli-gh/data ✔ (last push 2023-10-11)	FREE	Catalogue + ATF of almost every tablet. The per-artifact export URLs I tried returned empty bodies or redirects (unverified).
SEAL: Sources of Early Akkadian Literature (HUJI)	https://seal.huji.ac.il/ ✔	FREE-WEB	OB/OAkk literary texts with translations. Coverage of OB Atraḫasīs/Gilgameš is expected but not checked here. See the sibling `../SEAL/`.

6. Comparative flood literature

→ `../Comparative-studies/INDEX.md` (49 items: 8 open-access PDFs downloaded, plus free-web, paid and library items).

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7. Paid resources worth buying, ranked for *this* project

#	Title	Publisher	Approx. price	E-book?	Why
1	Tawil, *An Akkadian Lexical Companion for Biblical Hebrew* (2009)	Ktav	≈ $80 softcover ($125 hardcover earlier)	none found	The only book organised **Hebrew root → Akkadian cognates and idioms**, which is this project's core comparison.
2	HALOT (Koehler–Baumgartner)	Brill	≈ $150–160 in Logos/Accordance (unverified)	yes (Logos, Accordance)	Systematic Akkadian comparanda for every Hebrew word. Covers what Klein/BDB lack.
3	Huehnergard, *A Grammar of Akkadian* 3rd ed. + *Key*	Eisenbrauns (now Penn State UP)	≈ $50–65 + $30–55 (unverified)	(unverified)	The reference grammar for checking normalisation and verbal forms. It has a Semitic cognates appendix.
4	Lambert & Millard, *Atra-ḫasīs: The Babylonian Story of the Flood* (1969; Eisenbrauns reprint 1999)	Eisenbrauns	≈ $40 (from the Comparative-studies survey)	(unverified)	The standard edition and philological commentary for Atraḫasīs. Complements Wasserman 2020 and eBL.
5	Mankowski, *Akkadian Loanwords in Biblical Hebrew* (HSS 47, 2000)	Eisenbrauns	(unverified; about $30–40)	(unverified)	A rigorous loanword list. Keeps the Hebrew comparisons honest.
6	Cohen, *Biblical Hapax Legomena in the Light of Akkadian and Ugaritic* (1978)	Scholars Press / SBL	used copies	no	Hapax explanations via Akkadian.
7	Borger, *Mesopotamisches Zeichenlexikon* (²2010)	Ugarit-Verlag	(unverified)	no	Only if sign-level palaeography becomes necessary. eBL/ORACC cover routine needs.
—	**Not worth buying:** CDA (€29; its full text is free in eBL); AHw (German, superseded for us); George, *The Babylonian Gilgamesh Epic* (OUP 2003, very expensive; George's revised edition and translation are free in the eBL corpus); Halloran v4 (amateur).				